

SCIENCE IS THE PATH TO KNOWLEDGE, AND FINDING OUT ABOUT HOW OUR UNIVERSE WORKS. YOU CAN'T BE A GEEK AND NOT KNOW YOUR SCIENCE!

SCIENCE RULES!

THIS MONTH IN THE SCIENCE SECTION:
The biggest holes in the world, Diagnose health problems on your phone, The scary phenomenon of musical hallucinations and innovation awards for students in India.



The science of pain

A new working hypothesis explains how pain in our body does not always result with tissue damage, but instead is generated by the Central Nervous System (CNS) and lives within the brain.

<http://dgit.in/brainPain>

WHAT'S NEW

Zika virus can possibly fight brain cancer

If anything qualifies as the worst health story of 2016, it would be the Zika virus. With its devastating effect on infants and the emergency declared by WHO, no one needs to be told how badly the virus affected the world. But as new research indicates, the virus could be a key in fighting brain cancer in adult humans.

Researchers from UC San Diego and Washington University in St. Louis injected the cancer cells in brains of mice with the virus and observed a significantly slower tumor growth as well as extended lifespans. On top of that, combining the



Zika treatment with chemotherapy gave even better results.

As of now, it is too early to decide if this is a definitive outcome that is going to lead to successful human

trials as well. On the other hand, this is just the first step and the researchers have indicated a desire to develop a safe strain of the Zika virus to go ahead with human trial sometime next year.

<http://dgit.in/ZikaCancer>

Exploring space with AI

Space-time distortions – sounds like something right out of science-fiction doesn't it? But gravitational waves (i.e ripples in the curvature of spacetime that propagate as waves at the speed of light) are very much real. Once proper analysis on gravitational waves is done, it allows us to see much further into the universe than we've ever seen before. And now, AI will help us speed this analysis up like never before.



A neural network developed by researchers at the Kavli Institute for Particle Astrophysics and Cosmology, a joint institute of Stanford Uni-

versity and the SLAC National Accelerator Laboratory, can identify and analyse images of 'gravitational lensing'. According to this phenomenon, initially suggested by Albert Einstein, giant masses, like stars, curve light around themselves, allowing us to look beyond what would have been normally visible with a conventional telescope mechanism. Continue reading: <http://dgit.in/AI4space>



Discussion on climate change

Researchers claim that scientific evidence for warming of the climate system is unequivocal. However, is this current trend of global warming actually the result of human activities? Our climate has changed throughout history... <http://dgit.in/NewClimate>



China banning all fossil fuel vehicles

After European countries such as the UK and France have led the way, China, the world's largest automobile market, has announced plans to ditch fossil fuels entirely, and is working on a timetable for the same right now. <http://dgit.in/ChinaFossil>



Simulated moon base expedition

The Lunar Expedition 1 mission that lasted for two weeks, experimenting with the changes of the crew's biological clocks, at the Habitat Lunares base in Poland is complete. You can learn more about the findings here: <http://dgit.in/MoonBase1>